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People at the Core

With its focus on new and emerging work strategies, TCS has successfully created a template of HR policies for other companies to follow

By **Prerna Lidhoo**

▶ **INDIA IS HOME** to many a successful and innovative company, but some stand out more than the rest. With policies focussing on issues ranging from employee benefits to creating a positive work environment and opportunities for growth to skill development, Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) has distinguished itself as a great place to work from one that is just good. In doing so, TCS is also setting the template for other firms to follow. And this has helped TCS emerge as the top-ranked firm in the BT-Taggd Best Companies to Work For in India ranking this year.

TCS—which will see Global Head of BFSI Business Group K. Krithivasan take over as CEO & MD from incumbent Rajesh Gopinathan on September 15—understands the importance of adapting and exploring new ways of working in the modern era. “It will help us improve the productivity and consistency of the work that gets delivered, reduce the need for governance, up the pace of delivery, and reduce the need for peripheral functions. There is an immediate and urgent need to provide organisational support for new and emerging work models,” says Milind Lakkad, EVP & CHRO at TCS.

Lakkad expects job definitions to evolve as platforms such as ChatGPT, Bard and AI cobots (collaborative robots) become ubiquitous. AI-based

1 TCS TOP ATTRIBUTES

- BUILD A PURPOSEFUL, HAPPY WORKPLACE
- CREATE A STIMULATING, REWARDING AND INCLUSIVE WORK ENVIRONMENT
- ASSOCIATES ENCOURAGED TO OWN THEIR LEARNING AND GROWTH

◀ **MAN ON A MISSION** Milind Lakkad, EVP & CHRO, TCS

tools/bots, Lakkad says, are being leveraged for a wide assortment of strategies with an emphasis on recruitment, talent management, etc. And investing in new tech skills has not only helped TCS stay in the game, but also remain up to date with emerging tech. “Cloud, DevOps and Data Science have now become horizontal skills driving talent development, and we have been incorporating these technologies in multiple proactive talent building investments,” he says.

For Lakkad, TCS’s core HR policy has a lot to do with attracting, developing and retaining diverse talent. “We believe in building a purpose-driven, happy workplace, where every employee is encouraged to follow their passion, thrive together and stay hungry. We strive to... create a stimulating, rewarding and inclusive workplace,” he explains. Talking of inclusion, TCS boasts 35.7 per cent female workers and recognises that a diverse and inclusive workforce is vital to drive innovation, foster creativity and guide business strategies. “This year, TCS reached a significant milestone to become one of the few firms in the world employing more than 200,000 women,” he says.

The company’s policies, too, create a more understanding and supportive environment for women to